

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 872

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dorothy McCorkle Wellford of Cordova.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Dorothy McCorkle Wellford; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Wellford was an exemplary volunteer whose service to First Presbyterian Church in Memphis and its soup kitchen, Meals on Wheels, and the Memphis community reflected a lifelong commitment to helping others; and

WHEREAS, through her abiding commitment to serving her church, her community, and this State, Mrs. Wellford gave freely of her time and talents in ways that reflected her deep sense of public service; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Wellford served First Presbyterian Church in Memphis as a substitute organist, elder, choir member, and member of the Women of the Church; she also served as moderator for the Presbytery-wide Women of the Church, for which she was awarded an honorary lifetime membership; and

WHEREAS, demonstrating great dedication, Mrs. Wellford provided flowers from her own gardens for worship services at First Presbyterian Church, growing, arranging, and placing floral arrangements each Sunday for approximately forty years; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Wellford was an avid tennis player who competed alongside her husband, Dabney Wellford, to whom she was married for sixty-three years prior to his passing in 2018; together, they competed in numerous United States Tennis Association leagues; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wellford coached women's tennis for many years and participated in the National Senior Olympics in mixed doubles tennis with her husband, and in women's doubles, earning a silver medal in the 80–85 age category with her women's partner; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Wellford and her husband led efforts for many years to collect and transport leftover baked goods from local businesses to the First Presbyterian Church Soup Kitchen and regularly provided nutritious, home-delivered meals and safety checks through Meals on Wheels and the Memphis Inter-Faith Association; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Wellford is survived by her children, Dabney (Carolyn) Wellford, Jr., Brandon (Charissa) Wellford, and Evelyn (Jon) Walker; grandchildren, Diana (Jason)Turner, Nicole Wellford, Robert Wellford, Anne (Daniel) Mitchell, and Mac Walker; great-grandson, Brisbane Turner; and nine nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Wellford leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Dorothy McCorkle Wellford, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Wellford.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.